

Ashi Portfolio — Project Setup Guide

Easy, step-by-step handover instructions for running this application locally

NON-TECHNICAL EDITION

Welcome! What is this project?

This is a complete full-stack website consisting of an animated interactive 3D/WebGL portfolio and a secure Node.js backend server with an SQLite database and image management admin panel. Everything runs locally on your machine with **just 1 tool required**.

1 The Only Prerequisite: Install Node.js

Node.js allows your computer to run the web server. If you don't already have it installed:

1. Visit the official website: <https://nodejs.org>
2. Click on the big green button labeled **LTS (Recommended for Most Users)**.
3. Run the installer file and click **Next > Next > Finish** (default settings are perfect).
4. To verify, open your terminal (**Command Prompt** or **PowerShell** on Windows, or **Terminal** on Mac) and type:

```
node -v  
# Should display a version like: v20.x.x or v22.x.x
```

2 Preparing and Sending the Project Files

If you are packaging the folder to send to someone else, keep it lightweight:

- **Do NOT include heavy cache folders:** If there is a `node_modules/` folder inside `server/`, delete it before creating the .zip. The new user will regenerate it cleanly in Step 3.
- **Make sure you include:** All website folders (`assets/` , `scripts/` , `styles/` , `gallery/` , `server/` , and `index.html`).
- **Unzip:** The recipient should extract the zip file onto their computer (e.g. Desktop or Downloads).

3 Install & Start the Server (3 Easy Commands)

Open your terminal, navigate inside the project folder, and enter these commands:

```
# 1. Move into the backend server directory
cd server

# 2. Install the required server dependencies automatically
npm install

# 3. Start the application
npm start
```

💡 **First time setup note:** If a `.env` file is missing inside the `server` folder, simply duplicate `.env.example` and rename it to `.env` before running `npm start`.

When the terminal says:

```
Ashi server running at http://localhost:3000
Database initialized and connected.
```

4 Viewing the Website & Admin Panel

Keep the terminal window open (do not close it while using the site), and open your favorite browser:

Destination	URL (Type in address bar)	What It Is
Main Portfolio	<code>http://localhost:3000</code>	The full interactive website with 3D canvas, intro, and project gallery.
Admin Panel	<code>http://localhost:3000/admin</code>	Upload artworks, manage projects, rearrange gallery, and edit bio.

Default Admin Credentials: Username is `admin`. (Configured in your `server/.env` file).



Quick Troubleshooting for Common Problems

Problem	Cause & Solution
'node' or 'npm' is not recognized	Node.js was installed while the terminal was open. Close the terminal completely and reopen it.
Error: Port 3000 is already in use	Another software on your computer is using port 3000. Open <code>server/.env</code> , change <code>PORT=3000</code> to <code>PORT=3005</code> , save, and restart.
Images appear blank	Ensure the <code>server/data/</code> and <code>gallery/</code> folders were included when unzipping.
How do I stop the server?	Press <code>Ctrl + C</code> in the terminal window to shut down the server.